AAPNA PEA: user guides

PEA (the Probation Period Evaluation Platform) runs the probation evaluations of everyone who joins AAPNA. It emails each reporting manager an evaluation form when one is due, chases them, collects their ratings and comments, and records the confirmation decision at the end. It replaces the Excel master sheet and the old Microsoft Forms process.

These are step-by-step guides for the people who use it. No technical knowledge is needed.

Guide	For
HR guide	The HR team, every day: the Dashboard, evaluations, Commandos, new joiners, links, reports
Admin guide	Admins: users, module access, settings, email templates, the Excel import, sent emails, the new joiner review email
Super Admin guide	Super Admins: managing admins and other Super Admins, deleting accounts
For managers and Commandos	Reporting managers, acting managers, project leaders and Commandos. None of them need a PEA account

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Who can do what

PEA has three kinds of account. An admin decides which one you have, and can switch individual screens on or off for HR users.

Account	Can
Super Admin	Everything an Admin can, plus manage admins and other Super Admins, and delete accounts
Admin	Everything in PEA: all screens, the **Admin Portal** (users and module access), change settings and email templates, run the Excel import, read **Sent emails**, delete a Commando
HR	The screens an admin has switched on for them. On those screens HR can do the daily work: send and chase evaluations, record decisions, confirm new joiners, share reports. HR can **read** Settings and Email templates but not change them

Some people never sign in. **Reporting managers** fill in the evaluation form from a link in their email, and can open a "my team" page. **Project leaders** are copied on the emails. **Commandos** can be given a link to see their own progress. See For managers and Commandos.

Everyone with an account can change their own password: click your name (top right) → **Change Password**, or use **Forgot password?** on the sign-in page.

Words used in PEA

Word	Meaning
Commando	Someone whose probation PEA tracks: a new joiner on probation
Fresher / Experienced	The two probation tracks. A **fresher** gets **6** evaluations, one every 30 days. An **experienced** hire gets **3**, one every 60 days. Both last 6 months
Evaluation	One rating of one Commando by their reporting manager, covering the period since the last one. "Evaluation 2 of 6"
Final evaluation	The last evaluation of the probation. It also asks the manager for the **confirmation decision**
Confirmation decision	**Confirmed**, **Not Confirmed**, **Extend for 1 month** or **Extend for 2 months**
Extension	Extra evaluations after an "Extend" decision, 30 days apart. A probation can never run past **8 months** (at most two extension evaluations)
Reporting manager (RM)	The person who receives and fills in the evaluation form
Acting manager	Someone HR sends **one** evaluation to while the reporting manager is away
Project leader (PL)	Copied on every evaluation email for their Commando
Date of joining (DOJ)	The date the schedule is counted from. For someone found in Microsoft 365 it is suggested from the date their account was created
Microsoft 365 check	PEA's daily look at the company directory: it finds new accounts (new joiners) and accounts that look like leavers
Archived	A Commando whose probation is over. Kept in full, read-only, out of the day-to-day lists

Rating scale (what managers see)

Rating	Meaning
5 — Exceptional	Sets new standards of performance
4 — Highly Satisfied	Always exceeds expectations
3 — Satisfied	Sometimes exceeds expectation
2 — Dissatisfied	Sometimes meets expectations
1 — Highly Dissatisfied	Needs development

Every evaluation has the same **seven questions**: Quality of Code / Work, Meeting Deadline, Communication & Presentation, Proactiveness, Skill Development, Cultural Fit, X-Factor. A comment is required on every question.

On screen, ratings are coloured **red** for 1–2, **blue** for 3 and **green** for 4–5. An average is coloured by its nearest whole number.

Evaluation statuses

Status	Meaning
Scheduled	Not due yet. PEA emails the reporting manager automatically on the due date
Waiting for manager	The link has been emailed; the manager has not opened it yet. Reminders go out automatically
Opened by manager	The manager has opened the link but not submitted it
Submitted	The manager has submitted. Ratings and comments can be read
Not sent yet	The due date has passed but the email has not gone. Something needs fixing (open it to see why)
Closed	No longer needed, so it will not be sent. For example, the probation was decided before it fell due
Needs attention (flag)	A submitted evaluation to read closely: not confirmed, extended, an average below 2.5, or a question rated 2 or lower

Hover over any status label in PEA and it explains itself.

How the year runs, in one paragraph

A new joiner is confirmed (from the New joiners screen, the review email, or by adding them by hand) → PEA works out their evaluation dates → on each due date, at the daily email time (11:00 by default), the reporting manager is emailed a form, with the project leader and the CC list copied → if the manager does not submit, reminders go 2 and 4 days later → when they submit, HR is notified and the ratings appear on the board → the final evaluation carries the confirmation decision → once the probation is decided, the Commando is archived the next morning.

Due dates that fall on a Saturday or Sunday move to the Monday.

When something goes wrong

- If PEA shows an error, note **what you were doing**, **the screen**, **the time** and **the exact message**, and send them to the PEA team.
- The top bar shows **No email is being sent** when PEA cannot send email (for example, email is paused in Settings). Hover over it to see why. Tell an admin straight away: it means managers are not being asked for evaluations.
- On any screen with a list, a refresh of the browser page loads the latest data.